

67 Complex agreement

One of the basic principles of English is that subjects and verbs must agree. Some subjects, however, can behave as singular or plural nouns depending on their context.

 **New language** Complex agreement

Aa Vocabulary Collective nouns

 **New skill** Using the correct agreement

67.1 KEY LANGUAGE COLLECTIVE NOUNS

Collective nouns have a singular form, but refer to a number of people or objects as a group. In US English they generally take a singular verb. In UK English they can often be used with either singular or plural verbs.

If the subject describes a singular body then the verb form **must** be singular.



The **team** **is** getting a new manager next year.

[The team as a whole is getting a new manager.]

The **team** **are** feeling excited about the news.

[Each individual member of the team is feeling excited.]

If the subject describes a collection of individuals, then the verb form can be plural in UK English.



67.2 FILL IN THE GAPS USING THE COLLECTIVE NOUNS IN THE PANEL

Some of my wife's _____ *family* _____ are coming to visit.



① The legal _____ in my office is the largest in the company.



② Members of the _____ are rehearsing in different rooms in the building.



③ The _____ is having an emergency meeting in New York.



④ The soccer _____ is arriving later this evening.



⑤ The entire _____ was delighted by the guest performer last night.



~~family~~

team

orchestra

government

department

audience

